SUMS OF POWERS OF INTEGERS: A COMPLETE FRAMEWORK FOR CLOSED FORMULAS

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Abstract. This manuscript provides an algorithm for deriving closed formulas for multi-fold sums of powers of integers by combining variations of Newton's interpolation formula with hockey-stick family identities for binomial coefficients.

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1. Historical Context

The story begins in ancient Greece, where discrete approximations were employed to obtain continuous areas through the method of exhaustion. In particular, Archimedes (287–212 BC) evaluated sums of squares while determining the area enclosed by his spiral [1], leading to calculations analogous to the modern identity

$$1^2 + 2^2 + 3^2 + \cdots + n^2 = \frac{n(n+1)(2n+1)}{6}.$$

Moving to early modern Europe, Pierre de Fermat (1601–1665) described the problem of finding formulas for sums of powers as *"perhaps the most beautiful problem of all arithmetic"* in his correspondence with Blaise Pascal (1623–1662). Fermat's contribution to the subject was substantial: he revived the study of figurate numbers and investigated their arithmetic properties, including what is now known as Fermat's polygonal number theorem. Applications of polygonal numbers to sums of powers are discussed extensively in [2, (2020)].

Meanwhile, Johann Faulhaber (1580–1635) investigated sums of powers in his celebrated work *Academia Algebrae* [3, (1631)]. His achievements were extraordinary, as he obtained formulas up to $\Sigma^1 n^{25} = 1^{25} + 2^{25} + \cdots + n^{25}$. Faulhaber explicitly tabulated formulas through the seventeenth power and provided sufficient information for determining higher cases, including the twenty-fifth power; the latter reconstruction was later carried out by Knuth in [4]. More importantly, Faulhaber discovered deep structural patterns, particularly the representation of odd-power sums as polynomials in triangular numbers. What remained missing was a completely general symbolic formula.

A major breakthrough was achieved by Jacob Bernoulli (1655–1705) in his posthumously published work *Ars Conjectandi* [5, (1713)]. There, Bernoulli introduced the numbers that

now bear his name, obtaining a general formula for arbitrary power sums

$$\sum_{k=1}^{n} k^p = \frac{1}{p+1} \sum_{r=0}^{p} \binom{p+1}{r} B_r n^{p+1-r}.$$

Here it is assumed that $B_1 = +\frac{1}{2}$. The choice of convention for B_1 has a long historical background; see [6, 7] for a detailed discussion. Bernoulli's formula supplied the missing symbolical framework for Faulhaber's observations, and completed the theory. Although the expression above is commonly known as Faulhaber's formula, its modern Bernoulli-number formulation originates from Bernoulli's work.

During the eighteenth and nineteenth centuries, the theory was further developed by Euler, Stirling, Jacobi, and many others through connections with finite differences, interpolation, generating functions, and special number sequences.

In 1993, Donald Knuth revisited the theory of sums of powers and opened a new direction of development. Building upon ideas of Carl Gustav Jacobi (1804–1851) and the work of Gessel and Viennot [8, (1989)], Knuth reexamined Faulhaber's results through the lens of modern enumerative combinatorics. Remarkably, Bernoulli numbers are not central to Knuth's approach. Instead, he derived formulas for power sums using special number sequences, including Stirling and central factorial numbers, together with binomial coefficients. Knuth also introduced the convenient notation $\Sigma^r n^m$ for r-fold sums of powers, which will be used throughout this paper.

In this manuscript, we show the role of Newton's interpolation formula in the derivation of identities for sums of powers. Our main result is an algorithm for obtaining closed-form expressions for power sums by combining variants of Newton's interpolation formula with binomial identities from the hockey-stick family. The results demonstrate that infinitely many distinct closed-form representations of sums of powers can be constructed in this manner.

2. Definitions and Notations

We now define the mathematical objects used throughout the manuscript. For multifold sums of powers, we use the notation provided by Donald Knuth in [4], because it is concise and convenient.

Definition 2.1 (Multifold sums of powers)**.** *For non-negative integers r, n, m*

$$\begin{aligned}\Sigma^0\, n^m &= n^m,\\ \Sigma^1\, n^m &= \Sigma^0\, 1^m + \Sigma^0\, 2^m + \cdots + \Sigma^0\, n^m,\\ \Sigma^{r+1}\, n^m &= \Sigma^r\, 1^m + \Sigma^r\, 2^m + \cdots + \Sigma^r\, n^m.\end{aligned}$$

We use the following notation for falling factorials.

Definition 2.2 (Falling factorials)**.** *For integers x, n*

$$(n)_k = \begin{cases} 1, & \text{if } k = 0,\\ n(n-1)(n-2)\cdots(n-k+1) = \prod_{j=0}^{k-1}(n-j), & \text{if } k > 0,\\ 0, & \text{else.}\end{cases}$$

We use the following notation for central factorials.

Definition 2.3 (Central factorials)**.** *For integers n, k*

$$n^{[k]} = \begin{cases} 0, & \text{if } k < 0,\\ 1, & \text{if } k = 0,\\ n\left(n+\frac{k}{2}-1\right)\left(n+\frac{k}{2}-2\right)\cdots\left(n-\frac{k}{2}+1\right) = n\left(n+\frac{k}{2}-1\right)_{k-1}, & \text{if } k > 0,\end{cases}$$

where $\left(n+\frac{k}{2}-1\right)_{k-1} = \prod_{j=0}^{k-2}\left(n+\frac{k}{2}-1-j\right)$ are falling factorials.

For the definition of generalized factorials, see J. F. Steffensen's work [9].

3. Auxiliary Lemmas

Lemma 3.1 (Central Newton's formula)**.** *For a function f defined on integers and arbitrary integers x, t*

$$f(x) = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{(x-t)^{[k]}}{k!} \delta^k f(t),$$

where $\delta^k f(t)$ denotes the k-th central finite difference

$$\delta^k f(t) = \sum_{j=0}^{k} (-1)^j \binom{k}{j} f\left(t + \tfrac{k}{2} - j\right),$$

and $(x-t)^{[k]}$ are central factorials defined by (2.3).

Proof. See [10, p. 462], and [11, section 2, eq. (19)], and [12, section 6, eq. (21)]. □

Lemma 3.2 (Newton's formula for powers)**.** *For integers $n, m \geq 0$, and an arbitrary integer t,*

$$n^m = \sum_{k=0}^{m} \frac{(n-t)^{[k]}}{k!} \delta^k t^m.$$

Proof. Special case of Lemma (3.1) for $f(n) = n^m$. □

Lemma 3.3 (Central factorials binomial form)**.** *For integers n and $k \neq 0$,*

$$\frac{n^{[k]}}{k!} = \frac{n}{k} \binom{n + \frac{k}{2} - 1}{k-1}.$$

Proof. We have

$$\frac{n^{[k]}}{k!} = \frac{n}{k!} \left(n + \frac{k}{2} - 1\right)_{k-1} = \frac{n}{k(k-1)!} \left(n + \frac{k}{2} - 1\right)_{k-1} = \frac{n}{k} \binom{n+\frac{k}{2}-1}{k-1},$$

because of the identity in falling factorials $\frac{(x)_n}{n!} = \binom{x}{n}$. □

Lemma 3.4 (Central factorials binomial form decomposition)**.** *For non-negative integers n, k,*

$$\frac{n^{[k]}}{k!} = \frac{n}{k} \binom{n + \frac{k}{2} - 1}{k-1} = \frac{1}{2} \left[\binom{n + \frac{k}{2}}{k} + \binom{n + \frac{k}{2} - 1}{k} \right].$$

Proof. We have $\binom{a}{k} = \frac{a}{k}\binom{a-1}{k-1}$. Let $a = n + \frac{k}{2}$, then

$$\binom{n+\frac{k}{2}}{k} = \frac{n+\frac{k}{2}}{k}\binom{n+\frac{k}{2}-1}{k-1} = \frac{n}{k}\binom{n+\frac{k}{2}-1}{k-1} + \frac{1}{2}\binom{n+\frac{k}{2}-1}{k-1}.$$

Thus,

$$\frac{n}{k}\binom{n+\frac{k}{2}-1}{k-1} = \binom{n+\frac{k}{2}}{k} - \frac{1}{2}\binom{n+\frac{k}{2}-1}{k-1}.$$

By moving under common denominator, and applying binomial recurrence yields

$$\frac{n}{k}\binom{n+\frac{k}{2}-1}{k-1} = \frac{1}{2}\left[2\binom{n+\frac{k}{2}}{k} - \binom{n+\frac{k}{2}-1}{k-1}\right] = \frac{1}{2}\left[\binom{n+\frac{k}{2}}{k} + \binom{n+\frac{k}{2}-1}{k} + \binom{n+\frac{k}{2}-1}{k-1} - \binom{n+\frac{k}{2}-1}{k-1}\right].$$

Thus, the statement follows. □

Lemma 3.5 (Newton's formula for powers decomposition)**.** *For non-negative integers n, m, and an arbitrary integer t,*

$$n^m = \frac{1}{2}\sum_{k=0}^{m}\left[\binom{n-t+\frac{k}{2}}{k} + \binom{n-t+\frac{k}{2}-1}{k}\right]\delta^k t^m.$$

Proof. By Lemma (3.2), and by Lemma (3.4). □

Lemma 3.6 (Generalized hockey-stick identity)**.** *For arbitrary integers a, b and j,*

$$\sum_{k=a}^{b}\binom{k}{j} = \binom{b+1}{j+1} - \binom{a}{j+1}.$$

Proof. We have, $\sum_{k=a}^{b}\binom{k}{j} = \binom{a}{j} + \binom{a+1}{j} + \cdots + \binom{b}{j} = \left(\sum_{k=0}^{b}\binom{k}{j}\right) - \left(\sum_{k=0}^{a-1}\binom{k}{j}\right)$. By hockey-stick identity $\sum_{k=0}^{n}\binom{k}{j} = \binom{n+1}{j+1}$ yields,

$$\sum_{k=a}^{b}\binom{k}{j} = \left(\sum_{k=0}^{b}\binom{k}{j}\right) - \left(\sum_{k=0}^{a-1}\binom{k}{j}\right) = \binom{b+1}{j+1} - \binom{a}{j+1}.$$

This completes the proof. □

Lemma 3.7 (Centered hockey-stick identity)**.** *For integer $n \geq 1$, and arbitrary integers t, k, r*

$$\sum_{j=1}^{n}\binom{j-t+\frac{k}{2}+r}{k} = \binom{n-t+\frac{k}{2}+r+1}{k+1} - \binom{1-t+\frac{k}{2}+r}{k+1}.$$

Proof. By setting $a = 1 - t + \frac{k}{2} + r$, and $b = n - t + \frac{k}{2} + r$ into Lemma (3.6) yields

$$\sum_{j=1}^{n} \binom{j-t+\frac{k}{2}+r}{k} = \sum_{j=1-t+\frac{k}{2}+r}^{n-t+\frac{k}{2}+r} \binom{j}{k} = \binom{n-t+\frac{k}{2}+r+1}{k+1} - \binom{1-t+\frac{k}{2}+r}{k+1}.$$

This completes the proof. □

Lemma 3.8 (Multifold sums of zero powers)**.** *For non-negative integers r, n*

$$\Sigma^r\, n^0 = \binom{r+n-1}{r}.$$

Proof.

(1) Let $r = 0$, then we have $\Sigma^0\, n^0 = 1$, by definition (2.1).

(2) Let $r = 1$, then we have $\Sigma^1\, n^0 = \sum_{k=1}^{n} 1 = \binom{n}{1}$.

(3) Let $r = 2$, then we have $\Sigma^2\, n^0 = \sum_{k=1}^{n} \binom{k}{1} = \binom{n+1}{2}$.

(4) Let $r = 3$, then we have $\Sigma^3\, n^0 = \sum_{k=1}^{n} \binom{k+1}{2} = \binom{n+2}{3}$.

(5) Similarly, for arbitrary integer r, by hockey-stick identity $\sum_{k=1}^{n} \binom{k}{r} = \binom{n+1}{r+1}$, yields $\Sigma^r\, n^0 = \sum_{k=1}^{n} \Sigma^{r-1}\, k^0 = \sum_{k=1}^{n} \binom{k+r-2}{r-1} = \binom{r+n-1}{r}$.

This completes the proof. □

Convention 3.9. *For all x*

$$x^0 = 1.$$

Donald Knuth gives an extensive discussion of the convention $x^0 = 1$ for all x, including zero, in Concrete Mathematics [13, p. 162], and in [14].

4. Ordinary Sums of Powers

By decomposing Newton's formula for powers (3.5), for non-negative integers n, m, and an arbitrary integer t, we have

$$\Sigma^1\, n^m = \frac{1}{2} \sum_{k=0}^{m} \left[\sum_{j=1}^{n} \binom{j-t+\frac{k}{2}}{k} + \sum_{j=1}^{n} \binom{j-t+\frac{k}{2}-1}{k} \right] \delta^k t^m.$$

The closed form of ordinary sums of powers now follows by setting $r = 0$ and $r = -1$ in Lemma (3.7). This gives closed forms for the sums $\sum_{j=1}^{n} \binom{j-t+\frac{k}{2}}{k}$, and $\sum_{j=1}^{n} \binom{j-t+\frac{k}{2}-1}{k}$, respectively. Therefore, we obtain the following proposition.

Proposition 4.1 (Ordinary sums of powers decomposition)**.** *For integers $n, m \geq 0$, and an arbitrary integer t,*

$$\Sigma^1 n^m = \frac{1}{2} \sum_{k=0}^{m} \left[\binom{n-t+\frac{k}{2}+1}{k+1} - \binom{1-t+\frac{k}{2}}{k+1} + \binom{n-t+\frac{k}{2}}{k+1} - \binom{-t+\frac{k}{2}}{k+1} \right] \delta^k t^m.$$

Note that we do not bother ourselves about fractions in upper index of binomial coefficients $\binom{n-t+\frac{k}{2}+1}{k+1}$, because binomial coefficient $\binom{n}{k}$ is a polynomial in n. The well-known identity in unsigned Stirling numbers of the first kind $\left[\begin{smallmatrix} n \\ k \end{smallmatrix}\right]$ shows it explicitly

$$\binom{n}{k} = \sum_{j=0}^{k} \frac{(-1)^{k-j}}{k!} \left[\begin{matrix} k \\ j \end{matrix}\right] n^j.$$

For example, for $\Sigma^1 n^2$ we have

Example 4.2 (Sums of squares in central differences)**.**

$$\begin{aligned}
t = 0: \quad \Sigma^1 n^2 &= \frac{t^2}{2}(2n) + \frac{\delta t^2}{2} n(1+n) + \frac{\delta^2 t^2}{2} \frac{n(1+3n+2n^2)}{6}, \\
t = 1: \quad \Sigma^1 n^2 &= \frac{t^2}{2}(2n) + \frac{\delta t^2}{2} n(n-1) + \frac{\delta^2 t^2}{2} \frac{n(1-3n+2n^2)}{6}, \\
t = 2: \quad \Sigma^1 n^2 &= \frac{t^2}{2}(2n) + \frac{\delta t^2}{2} n(n-3) + \frac{\delta^2 t^2}{2} \frac{n(13-9n+2n^2)}{6}, \\
t = 3: \quad \Sigma^1 n^2 &= \frac{t^2}{2}(2n) + \frac{\delta t^2}{2} n(n-5) + \frac{\delta^2 t^2}{2} \frac{n(37-15n+2n^2)}{6}, \\
t = 4: \quad \Sigma^1 n^2 &= \frac{t^2}{2}(2n) + \frac{\delta t^2}{2} n(n-7) + \frac{\delta^2 t^2}{2} \frac{n(73-21n+2n^2)}{6}.
\end{aligned}$$

For example, for $\Sigma^1 n^3$ we have

Example 4.3 (Sums of cubes in central differences)**.**

$$t=0: \quad \Sigma^1 n^3 = \tfrac{t^3}{2}(2n) + \tfrac{\delta t^3}{2} n(1+n) + \tfrac{\delta^2 t^3}{2} \tfrac{n(1+3n+2n^2)}{6} + \tfrac{\delta^3 t^3}{2} \tfrac{n(-1+n+4n^2+2n^3)}{24},$$

$$t=1: \quad \Sigma^1 n^3 = \tfrac{t^3}{2}(2n) + \tfrac{\delta t^3}{2} n(n-1) + \tfrac{\delta^2 t^3}{2} \tfrac{n(1-3n+2n^2)}{6} + \tfrac{\delta^3 t^3}{2} \tfrac{n(1+n-4n^2+2n^3)}{24},$$

$$t=2: \quad \Sigma^1 n^3 = \tfrac{t^3}{2}(2n) + \tfrac{\delta t^3}{2} n(n-3) + \tfrac{\delta^2 t^3}{2} \tfrac{n(13-9n+2n^2)}{6} + \tfrac{\delta^3 t^3}{2} \tfrac{n(-21+25n-12n^2+2n^3)}{24},$$

$$t=3: \quad \Sigma^1 n^3 = \tfrac{t^3}{2}(2n) + \tfrac{\delta t^3}{2} n(n-5) + \tfrac{\delta^2 t^3}{2} \tfrac{n(37-15n+2n^2)}{6} + \tfrac{\delta^3 t^3}{2} \tfrac{n(-115+73n-20n^2+2n^3)}{24},$$

$$t=4: \quad \Sigma^1 n^3 = \tfrac{t^3}{2}(2n) + \tfrac{\delta t^3}{2} n(n-7) + \tfrac{\delta^2 t^3}{2} \tfrac{n(73-21n+2n^2)}{6} + \tfrac{\delta^3 t^3}{2} \tfrac{n(-329+145n-28n^2+2n^3)}{24}.$$

The formula in Proposition (4.1) is also connected with the central factorial numbers of the second kind $T(n,k)$.

Proposition 4.4 (Central factorial numbers sums)**.** *For non-negative integers n, m, and an arbitrary integer t,*

$$\Sigma^1 n^m = \frac{1}{2} \sum_{k=0}^{m} \left[\binom{n+\frac{k}{2}+1}{k+1} - \binom{1+\frac{k}{2}}{k+1} + \binom{n+\frac{k}{2}}{k+1} - \binom{\frac{k}{2}}{k+1} \right] k! T(m,k),$$

where $T(m,k)$ are central factorial numbers of the second kind (in Riordan's notation). See [12, p. 213]*, and* [15].

These central factorial numbers of the second kind $T(n,k)$ are defined by central Newton's formula for powers (3.2) evaluated at zero, such that

$$n^m = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} T(m,k) n^{[k]}.$$

This implies

$$T(n,k) = \frac{\delta^k 0^m}{k!},$$

by Newton's formula (3.2).

5. Remark on Knuth's Formula for Sums of Odd Powers

Donald Knuth gives a formula for sums of odd powers in terms of the central factorial numbers of the second kind $T(n,k)$ in [4].

Proposition 5.1 (Knuth's odd powers sum)**.** *Let n be a nonnegative integer, and let m be a positive integer.*

$$\Sigma^1 n^{2m-1} = \sum_{k=1}^{m} (2k-1)! \binom{n+k}{2k} T(2m, 2k),$$

where $T(2m,2k)$ are central factorial numbers of the second kind.

The sequences A008957, A036969, and A269945 list central factorial numbers of the second kind $T(n,k)$ in the OEIS, as described in [16]. Table 1 lists initial values of $T(2n,2k)$.

n/k	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
0	1							
1	0	1						
2	0	1	1					
3	0	1	5	1				
4	0	1	21	14	1			
5	0	1	85	147	30	1		
6	0	1	341	1408	627	55	1	
7	0	1	1365	13013	11440	2002	91	1

Table 1. Central factorial numbers of the second kind $T(2n,2k)$.

It is interesting to notice that Proposition (5.1) directly follows from Central Newton's Formula in Lemma (3.2), evaluated at zero. For $m \geq 1$, the formula gives

$$n^{2m} = \sum_{k=1}^{2m} \frac{n^{[k]}}{k!} \cdot \delta^k 0^{2m}.$$

The term for $k = 0$ vanishes because $\delta^0 0^{2m} = 0$ when $m \geq 1$. For positive integers m and k, the central difference $\delta^k 0^m$ is nonzero exactly when $k \leq m$ and m and k have the same

parity:

$$\begin{cases} \delta^k 0^m \neq 0, & \text{when} \quad m \equiv k \pmod 2, \\ \delta^k 0^m = 0, & \text{when} \quad m \not\equiv k \pmod 2, \end{cases}$$

In particular, the difference vanishes when m and k have opposite parity. This parity property applies to powers evaluated at zero; for example, $\delta^3 1^4 = 24 \neq 0$. Since $2m$ is even, the differences $\delta^k 0^{2m}$ vanish for odd k, so we may omit those terms:

$$n^{2m} = \sum_{k=1}^{m} \frac{n^{[2k]}}{(2k)!} \cdot \delta^{2k} 0^{2m}.$$

By the definition of the central factorial numbers of the second kind, we obtain

$$n^{2m} = \sum_{k=1}^{m} n^{[2k]} T(2m, 2k).$$

Therefore,

$$n^{2m} = \sum_{k=1}^{m} (2k)! \frac{n^{[2k]}}{(2k)!} T(2m, 2k).$$

Applying Lemma (3.3) to simplify $\frac{n^{[2k]}}{(2k)!}$ gives

$$n^{2m} = \sum_{k=1}^{m} (2k)! \frac{n}{2k} \binom{n+k-1}{2k-1} T(2m, 2k).$$

Consequently,

$$n^{2m} = \sum_{k=1}^{m} (2k-1)! n \binom{n+k-1}{2k-1} T(2m, 2k).$$

Factoring out n gives

$$n^{2m-1} = \sum_{k=1}^{m} (2k-1)! \binom{n+k-1}{2k-1} T(2m, 2k).$$

Applying the hockey-stick identity $\sum_{k=0}^{n} \binom{k}{j} = \binom{n+1}{j+1}$ gives

$$\Sigma^1 \, n^{2m-1} = \sum_{k=1}^{m} (2k-1)! \binom{n+k}{2k} T(2m, 2k).$$

This formula agrees with Proposition (5.1). Repeated application of the hockey-stick identity $\sum_{k=0}^{n} \binom{k}{j} = \binom{n+1}{j+1}$ generalizes the formula to multifold sums.

Proposition 5.2 (Knuth's odd powers sum multifold)**.** *Let r and n be nonnegative integers, and let m be a positive integer.*

$$\Sigma^{r+1}\, n^{2m-1} = \sum_{k=1}^{m} (2k-1)! \binom{n+k+r}{2k+r} T(2m, 2k),$$

where $T(2m, 2k)$ are central factorial numbers of the second kind.

The following example illustrates Proposition (5.1).

Example 5.3. *For non-negative integers n, and $r = 1$, we have*

$$\Sigma^1\, n^1 = \tbinom{n+1}{2} 1,$$

$$\Sigma^1\, n^3 = \tbinom{n+2}{4} 6 + \tbinom{n+1}{2} 1,$$

$$\Sigma^1\, n^5 = \tbinom{n+3}{6} 120 + \tbinom{n+2}{4} 30 + \tbinom{n+1}{2} 1,$$

$$\Sigma^1\, n^7 = \tbinom{n+4}{8} 5040 + \tbinom{n+3}{6} 1680 + \tbinom{n+2}{4} 126 + \tbinom{n+1}{2} 1.$$

The following example illustrates Proposition (5.2).

Example 5.4. *For non-negative integers r, n*

$$\Sigma^r\, n^1 = \tbinom{n+0+r}{1+r} 1,$$

$$\Sigma^r\, n^3 = \tbinom{n+1+r}{3+r} 6 + \tbinom{n+0+r}{1+r} 1,$$

$$\Sigma^r\, n^5 = \tbinom{n+2+r}{5+r} 120 + \tbinom{n+1+r}{3+r} 30 + \tbinom{n+0+r}{1+r} 1,$$

$$\Sigma^r\, n^7 = \tbinom{n+3+r}{7+r} 5040 + \tbinom{n+3+r}{5+r} 1680 + \tbinom{n+1+r}{3+r} 126 + \tbinom{n+0+r}{1+r} 1.$$

The coefficients in Proposition (5.2) form the sequence A303675 in the OEIS, as listed in [16]. Proposition (5.2) also motivates the following identity. Combining Newton's formula in Lemma (3.2) with Lemma (3.3) gives

$$n^m = \sum_{k=1}^{m} \frac{n}{k} \binom{n + \frac{k}{2} - 1}{k-1} \delta^k 0^m.$$

Factoring out n gives

$$n^{m-1} = \sum_{k=1}^{m} \frac{1}{k} \binom{n + \frac{k}{2} - 1}{k-1} \delta^k 0^m.$$

Shifting the exponent gives

$$n^{m} = \sum_{k=1}^{m+1} \frac{1}{k} \binom{n + \frac{k}{2} - 1}{k-1} \delta^k 0^{m+1}.$$

Re-indexing the sum gives

$$n^{m} = \sum_{k=0}^{m} \frac{1}{k+1} \binom{n + \frac{k}{2} - \frac{1}{2}}{k} \delta^{k+1} 0^{m+1}. \tag{1}$$

Setting $r = 0$ and $t = \frac{1}{2}$ in Lemma (3.7) gives the following proposition.

Proposition 5.5 (Ordinary sums of powers at zero)**.** *Let n and m be nonnegative integers.*

$$\Sigma^1 n^m = \sum_{k=0}^{m} \left[\binom{n + \frac{k}{2} + \frac{1}{2}}{k+1} - \binom{\frac{k}{2} + \frac{1}{2}}{k+1} \right] \frac{\delta^{k+1} 0^{m+1}}{k+1}.$$

The formula can also be written in terms of central factorial numbers of the second kind:

$$\Sigma^1 n^m = \sum_{k=0}^{m} k! \left[\binom{n + \frac{k}{2} + \frac{1}{2}}{k+1} - \binom{\frac{k}{2} + \frac{1}{2}}{k+1} \right] T(k+1, m+1).$$

Setting $r = 1$ and $t = \frac{1}{2}$ in Lemma (3.7) gives a formula for double sums of powers.

Proposition 5.6 (Double sums of powers at zero)**.** *Let n and m be nonnegative integers.*

$$\Sigma^2 n^m = \sum_{k=0}^{m} \left[\binom{n + \frac{k}{2} + \frac{3}{2}}{k+2} - \binom{\frac{k}{2} + \frac{1}{2}}{k+1} \Sigma^1 n^0 - \binom{\frac{k}{2} + \frac{3}{2}}{k+2} \Sigma^0 n^0 \right] \frac{\delta^{k+1} 0^{m+1}}{k+1}.$$

The general formula is as follows.

Theorem 5.7 (Multifold sums of powers at zero)**.** *Let r, n, and m be nonnegative integers.*

$$\Sigma^r n^m = \sum_{k=0}^{m} \left[\binom{n + \frac{k}{2} + \frac{2r-1}{2}}{k+r} - \sum_{s=0}^{r-1} \binom{\frac{k}{2} + \frac{2(r-s)-1}{2}}{k+r-s} \Sigma^s n^0 \right] \frac{\delta^{k+1} 0^{m+1}}{k+1}.$$

Proof. By repeatedly applied Lemma (3.7), and Equation (1). □

Combining Lemma (3.8) with Theorem (5.7) gives the following binomial form.

Proposition 5.8 (Multifold sums of powers at zero binomial form)**.** *Let r, n, and m be nonnegative integers.*

$$\Sigma^r\, n^m = \sum_{k=0}^{m} \left[\binom{n + \frac{k}{2} + \frac{2r-1}{2}}{k+r} - \sum_{s=0}^{r-1} \binom{\frac{k}{2} + \frac{2(r-s)-1}{2}}{k+r-s} \binom{s+n-1}{s} \right] \frac{\delta^{k+1} 0^{m+1}}{k+1}.$$

Proof. By repeatedly applied Lemma (3.7), and Equation (1). □

This formula can also be expressed in terms of central factorial numbers of the second kind:

$$\Sigma^r\, n^m = \sum_{k=0}^{m} \left[\binom{n + \frac{k}{2} + \frac{2r-1}{2}}{k+r} - \sum_{s=0}^{r-1} \binom{\frac{k}{2} + \frac{2(r-s)-1}{2}}{k+r-s} \binom{s+n-1}{s} \right] k! T(k+1, m+1).$$

The results above follow from evaluating the central Newton formula at zero. Table 2 lists initial values of $T(n,k)$.

6. Generalized Central Factorial Numbers of the Second Kind

Definition 6.1 (Generalized central factorial numbers of the second kind)**.** *For integers $0 \le k \le m$, and an arbitrary integer t, the generalized central factorial numbers of the second kind are defined by the relation*

$$n^m = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} T_t(m,k) \cdot (n-t)^{[k]}.$$

It is also straightforward that

$$T_t(m,k) = \frac{\delta^k t^m}{k!},$$

by Newton's formula (3.2). For example, for $T_0(n,k)$ we have

n/k	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
0	1								
1	0	1							
2	0	0	1						
3	0	$\frac{1}{4}$	0	1					
4	0	0	1	0	1				
5	0	$\frac{1}{16}$	0	$\frac{5}{2}$	0	1			
6	0	0	1	0	5	0	1		
7	0	$\frac{1}{64}$	0	$\frac{91}{16}$	0	$\frac{35}{4}$	0	1	
8	0	0	1	0	21	0	14	0	1

Table 2. Values of generalized central factorial numbers $T_0(n,k)$. See also the sequences A395862, and A370703 in the OEIS [16].

For example, for $T_1(n,k)$ we have

n/k	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
0	1								
1	1	1							
2	1	2	1						
3	1	$\frac{13}{4}$	3	1					
4	1	5	7	4	1				
5	1	$\frac{121}{16}$	15	$\frac{25}{2}$	5	1			
6	1	$\frac{91}{8}$	31	35	20	6	1		
7	1	$\frac{1093}{64}$	63	$\frac{1491}{16}$	70	$\frac{119}{4}$	7	1	
8	1	$\frac{205}{8}$	127	$\frac{483}{2}$	231	126	42	8	1

Table 3. Values of generalized central factorial numbers $T_1(n,k)$. See also the sequences A395860, and A395861 in the OEIS [16].

For example, for $T_2(n,k)$ we have

n/k	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
0	1								
1	2	1							
2	4	4	1						
3	8	$\frac{49}{4}$	6	1					
4	16	34	25	8	1				
5	32	$\frac{1441}{16}$	90	$\frac{85}{2}$	10	1			
6	64	$\frac{931}{4}$	301	190	65	12	1		
7	128	$\frac{37969}{64}$	966	$\frac{12411}{16}$	350	$\frac{371}{4}$	14	1	
8	256	$\frac{6001}{4}$	3025	3003	1701	588	126	16	1

Table 4. Values of generalized central factorial numbers $T_2(n,k)$. See also the sequences A394466, and A395314 in the OEIS [16].

For example, for $T_3(n,k)$ we have

n/k	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
0	1								
1	3	1							
2	9	6	1						
3	27	$\frac{109}{4}$	9	1					
4	81	111	55	12	1				
5	243	$\frac{6841}{16}$	285	$\frac{185}{2}$	15	1			
6	729	$\frac{12753}{8}$	1351	585	140	18	1		
7	2187	$\frac{372709}{64}$	6069	$\frac{53011}{16}$	1050	$\frac{791}{4}$	21	1	
8	6561	$\frac{167943}{8}$	26335	$\frac{35049}{2}$	6951	1722	266	24	1

Table 5. Values of generalized central factorial numbers $T_3(n,k)$. See also the sequences A396559, and A395861 in the OEIS [16].

Table 6 lists values of $T_t(2n,2k)$ for $0 \le t \le 3$.

t	$T_t(2m, 2k)$	OEIS ID
0	$1, 0, 1, 0, 1, 1, 0, 1, 5, 1, 0, 1, 21, 14, 1, 0, 1, 85, 147, 30, 1, 0, 1, \cdots$	A269945
1	$1, 1, 1, 1, 7, 1, 1, 31, 20, 1, 1, 127, 231, 42, 1, 1, 511, 2290, 987, \cdots$	A394692
2	$1, 4, 1, 16, 25, 1, 64, 301, 65, 1, 256, 3025, 1701, 126, 1, 1024, \cdots$	A395456
3	$1, 9, 1, 81, 55, 1, 729, 1351, 140, 1, 6561, 26335, 6951, 266, 1, \cdots$	A395457

Table 6. Sequences of $T_t(2m, 2k)$.

Thus, we obtain the formula for sums of powers in terms of generalized central factorial numbers of the second kind

Proposition 6.2 (Generalized Central factorial sums)**.** *For non-negative integers n, m, and an arbitrary integer t,*

$$\Sigma^1 n^m = \frac{1}{2}\sum_{k=0}^{m}\left[\binom{n-t+\frac{k}{2}+1}{k+1} - \binom{1-t+\frac{k}{2}}{k+1} + \binom{n-t+\frac{k}{2}}{k+1} - \binom{0-t+\frac{k}{2}}{k+1}\right] k! T_t(m,k).$$

7. Double and Triple Sums of Powers in Terms of Central Differences

The same method gives closed forms for double sums of powers. Lemma (3.7) and Proposition (4.1) reduce the calculation to the sums $\sum_{j=1}^{n}\binom{j-t+\frac{k}{2}+1}{k+1}$, and $\sum_{j=1}^{n}\binom{j-t+\frac{k}{2}}{k+1}$. Evaluating these sums gives the following proposition.

Proposition 7.1 (Double sums of powers decomposition)**.** *For non-negative integers n, m, and an arbitrary integer t,*

$$\begin{aligned}\Sigma^2 n^m = \frac{1}{2}\sum_{k=0}^{m}\Bigg[&+\binom{n-t+\frac{k}{2}+2}{k+2} - \binom{2-t+\frac{k}{2}}{k+2}\Sigma^0 n^0 - \binom{1-t+\frac{k}{2}}{k+1}\Sigma^1 n^0 \\ &+\binom{n-t+\frac{k}{2}+1}{k+2} - \binom{1-t+\frac{k}{2}}{k+2}\Sigma^0 n^0 - \binom{0-t+\frac{k}{2}}{k+1}\Sigma^1 n^0\Bigg]\delta^k t^m.\end{aligned}$$

For example, for $\Sigma^2 n^2$ we have

Example 7.2 (Double sum of squares in central differences)**.** *For integer* $0 \le t \le 4$

$$
\begin{aligned}
t=0: &\quad \Sigma^2\, n^2 = \frac{t^2}{2}\, n(1+n) + \frac{\delta t^2}{2}\, \frac{n(2+3n+n^2)}{3} + \frac{\delta^2 t^2}{2}\, \frac{n(1+n)^2(2+n)}{12},\\
t=1: &\quad \Sigma^2\, n^2 = \frac{t^2}{2}\, n(1+n) + \frac{\delta t^2}{2}\, \frac{n(-1+n^2)}{3} + \frac{\delta^2 t^2}{2}\, \frac{n^2(-1+n^2)}{12},\\
t=2: &\quad \Sigma^2\, n^2 = \frac{t^2}{2}\, n(1+n) + \frac{\delta t^2}{2}\, \frac{n(-4-3n+n^2)}{3} + \frac{\delta^2 t^2}{2}\, \frac{n(10+5n-4n^2+n^3)}{12},\\
t=3: &\quad \Sigma^2\, n^2 = \frac{t^2}{2}\, n(1+n) + \frac{\delta t^2}{2}\, \frac{n(-7-6n+n^2)}{3} + \frac{\delta^2 t^2}{2}\, \frac{n(32+23n-8n^2+n^3)}{12},\\
t=4: &\quad \Sigma^2\, n^2 = \frac{t^2}{2}\, n(1+n) + \frac{\delta t^2}{2}\, \frac{n(-10-9n+n^2)}{3} + \frac{\delta^2 t^2}{2}\, \frac{n(66+53n-12n^2+n^3)}{12}.
\end{aligned}
$$

Repeating the procedure above gives the following formula for triple sums of powers.

Proposition 7.3 (Triple sums of powers decomposition)**.** *For non-negative integers* n, m*, and an arbitrary integer* t*,*

$$
\begin{aligned}
\Sigma^3\, n^m = \frac{1}{2} \sum_{k=0}^{m} \Bigg[& \\
& + \binom{n-t+\frac{k}{2}+3}{k+3} - \binom{3-t+\frac{k}{2}}{k+3} \Sigma^0\, n^0 - \binom{2-t+\frac{k}{2}}{k+2} \Sigma^1\, n^0 - \binom{1-t+\frac{k}{2}}{k+1} \Sigma^2\, n^0 \\
& + \binom{n-t+\frac{k}{2}+2}{k+3} - \binom{2-t+\frac{k}{2}}{k+3} \Sigma^0\, n^0 - \binom{1-t+\frac{k}{2}}{k+2} \Sigma^1\, n^0 - \binom{0-t+\frac{k}{2}}{k+1} \Sigma^2\, n^0 \Bigg] \delta^k t^m.
\end{aligned}
$$

For example, for $\Sigma^3\, n^2$ we have

Example 7.4 (Triple sum of squares in central differences)**.** *For integer* $0 \le t \le 4$

$$
\begin{aligned}
t=0: &\quad \Sigma^3\, n^2 = \tfrac{t^2}{2}\, \tfrac{n(2+3n+n^2)}{3} + \tfrac{\delta t^2}{2}\, \tfrac{n(6+11n+6n^2+n^3)}{12} + \tfrac{\delta^2 t^2}{2}\, \tfrac{n(18+45n+40n^2+15n^3+2n^4)}{120},\\
t=1: &\quad \Sigma^3\, n^2 = \tfrac{t^2}{2}\, \tfrac{n(2+3n+n^2)}{3} + \tfrac{\delta t^2}{2}\, \tfrac{n(-2-n+2n^2+n^3)}{12} + \tfrac{\delta^2 t^2}{2}\, \tfrac{n(-2-5n+5n^3+2n^4)}{120},\\
t=2: &\quad \Sigma^3\, n^2 = \tfrac{t^2}{2}\, \tfrac{n(2+3n+n^2)}{3} + \tfrac{\delta t^2}{2}\, \tfrac{n(-10-13n-2n^2+n^3)}{12} + \tfrac{\delta^2 t^2}{2}\, \tfrac{n(58+65n-5n^3+2n^4)}{120},\\
t=3: &\quad \Sigma^3\, n^2 = \tfrac{t^2}{2}\, \tfrac{n(2+3n+n^2)}{3} + \tfrac{\delta t^2}{2}\, \tfrac{n(-18-25n-6n^2+n^3)}{12} + \tfrac{\delta^2 t^2}{2}\, \tfrac{n(198+255n+40n^2-15n^3+2n^4)}{120},\\
t=4: &\quad \Sigma^3\, n^2 = \tfrac{t^2}{2}\, \tfrac{n(2+3n+n^2)}{3} + \tfrac{\delta t^2}{2}\, \tfrac{n(-26-37n-10n^2+n^3)}{12} + \tfrac{\delta^2 t^2}{2}\, \tfrac{n(418+565n+120n^2-25n^3+2n^4)}{120}.
\end{aligned}
$$

8. Multifold Sums of Powers in Terms of Central Differences

By applying Lemma (3.7) on formula for ordinary sums of powers (4.1) repeatedly, the formula for multifold sums of powers follows

Theorem 8.1 (Multifold sums of powers)**.** *For non-negative integers n, m, and an arbitrary integer t,*

$$\Sigma^r\, n^m = \frac{1}{2}\sum_{k=0}^{m}\left\{\binom{n-t+\frac{k}{2}+r}{k+r}+\binom{n-t+\frac{k}{2}+r-1}{k+r}\right.$$
$$\left.-\sum_{s=0}^{r-1}\left[\binom{r-s-t+\frac{k}{2}}{k+r-s}+\binom{r-1-s-t+\frac{k}{2}}{k+r-s}\right]\Sigma^s\, n^0\right\}\delta^k t^m.$$

For example,

Example 8.2 (Examples of multifold sums)**.** *For integer $0 \le t \le 2$*

$$t=0:\quad \Sigma^r\, n^m = \tfrac{1}{2}\sum_{k=0}^{m}\left\{\tbinom{n+\frac{k}{2}+r}{k+r}+\tbinom{n+\frac{k}{2}+r-1}{k+r}\right.$$
$$\left.-\sum_{s=0}^{r-1}\left[\tbinom{r-s+\frac{k}{2}}{k+r-s}+\tbinom{r-1-s+\frac{k}{2}}{k+r-s}\right]\Sigma^s\, n^0\right\}\delta^k 0^m,$$

$$t=1:\quad \Sigma^r\, n^m = \tfrac{1}{2}\sum_{k=0}^{m}\left\{\tbinom{n-1+\frac{k}{2}+r}{k+r}+\tbinom{n-1+\frac{k}{2}+r-1}{k+r}\right.$$
$$\left.-\sum_{s=0}^{r-1}\left[\tbinom{r-s-1+\frac{k}{2}}{k+r-s}+\tbinom{r-2-s+\frac{k}{2}}{k+r-s}\right]\Sigma^s\, n^0\right\}\delta^k 1^m,$$

$$t=2:\quad \Sigma^r\, n^m = \tfrac{1}{2}\sum_{k=0}^{m}\left\{\tbinom{n-2+\frac{k}{2}+r}{k+r}+\tbinom{n-2+\frac{k}{2}+r-1}{k+r}\right.$$
$$\left.-\sum_{s=0}^{r-1}\left[\tbinom{r-s-2+\frac{k}{2}}{k+r-s}+\tbinom{r-3-s+\frac{k}{2}}{k+r-s}\right]\Sigma^s\, n^0\right\}\delta^k 2^m.$$

9. Multifold Sums of Powers in Generalized Central Factorial Numbers

By definition (6.1), from Theorem (8.1) follows

Proposition 9.1 (Multifold central factorial sums of powers)**.** *For non-negative integers n, m, and an arbitrary integer t,*

$$\Sigma^r\, n^m = \frac{1}{2}\sum_{k=0}^{m}\left\{\binom{n-t+\frac{k}{2}+r}{k+r}+\binom{n-t+\frac{k}{2}+r-1}{k+r}\right.$$
$$\left.-\sum_{s=0}^{r-1}\left[\binom{r-s-t+\frac{k}{2}}{k+r-s}+\binom{r-1-s-t+\frac{k}{2}}{k+r-s}\right]\Sigma^s\, n^0\right\}k!T_t(m,k).$$

For example, for $\Sigma^1\, n^2$ we have

Example 9.2 (Sums of squares in central factorial numbers)**.** *For integer $0 \le t \le 5$*

$$t=0: \quad \Sigma^1\, n^2 = n\cdot 0+\tfrac{1}{2}n(1+n)\cdot 0+\tfrac{1}{6}n(1+3n+2n^2)\cdot 1,$$
$$t=1: \quad \Sigma^1\, n^2 = n\cdot 1+\tfrac{1}{2}n(n-1)\cdot 2+\tfrac{1}{6}n(1-3n+2n^2)\cdot 1,$$
$$t=2: \quad \Sigma^1\, n^2 = n\cdot 4+\tfrac{1}{2}n(n-3)\cdot 4+\tfrac{1}{6}n(13-9n+2n^2)\cdot 1,$$
$$t=3: \quad \Sigma^1\, n^2 = n\cdot 9+\tfrac{1}{2}n(n-5)\cdot 6+\tfrac{1}{6}n(37-15n+2n^2)\cdot 1,$$
$$t=4: \quad \Sigma^1\, n^2 = n\cdot 16+\tfrac{1}{2}n(n-7)\cdot 8+\tfrac{1}{6}n(73-21n+2n^2)\cdot 1,$$
$$t=5: \quad \Sigma^1\, n^2 = n\cdot 25+\tfrac{1}{2}n(n-9)\cdot 10+\tfrac{1}{6}n(121-27n+2n^2)\cdot 1.$$

From the example above, we may observe that

- For $t=0$ the coefficients $0,0,1$ correspond to the second row of the triangle (2).
- For $t=1$ the coefficients $1,2,1$ correspond to the second row of the triangle (3).
- For $t=2$ the coefficients $4,4,1$ correspond to the second row of the triangle (4).
- For $t=3$ the coefficients $9,6,1$ correspond to the second row of the triangle (5).

For example, for $\Sigma^1\, n^4$ we have

Example 9.3 (Sums of fourth powers in central factorial numbers)**.** *For integer* $0 \leq t \leq 3$

$$
\begin{aligned}
t=0: \quad \Sigma^1\, n^4 &= n\cdot 0 + \tfrac{1}{2}n(1+n)\cdot 0 + \tfrac{1}{6}n(1+3n+2n^2)\cdot 1 \\
&\quad + \tfrac{1}{8}n(-1+n+4n^2+2n^3)\cdot 0 + \tfrac{1}{10}n(-2-5n+5n^3+2n^4)\cdot 1, \\
t=1: \quad \Sigma^1\, n^4 &= n\cdot 1 + \tfrac{1}{2}n(n-1)\cdot 5 + \tfrac{1}{6}n(1-3n+2n^2)\cdot 7 \\
&\quad + \tfrac{1}{8}n(1+n-4n^2+2n^3)\cdot 4 + \tfrac{1}{10}n(-2+5n-5n^3+2n^4)\cdot 1, \\
t=2: \quad \Sigma^1\, n^4 &= n\cdot 16 + \tfrac{1}{2}n(n-3)\cdot 34 + \tfrac{1}{6}n(13-9n+2n^2)\cdot 25 \\
&\quad + \tfrac{1}{8}n(-21+25n-12n^2+2n^3)\cdot 8 \\
&\quad + \tfrac{1}{10}n(18-45n+40n^2-15n^3+2n^4)\cdot 1, \\
t=3: \quad \Sigma^1\, n^4 &= n\cdot 81 + \tfrac{1}{2}n(n-5)\cdot 111 + \tfrac{1}{6}n(37-15n+2n^2)\cdot 55 \\
&\quad + \tfrac{1}{8}n(-115+73n-20n^2+2n^3)\cdot 12 \\
&\quad + \tfrac{1}{10}n(298-275n+120n^2-25n^3+2n^4)\cdot 1.
\end{aligned}
$$

From the example above, we may observe that

- For $t=0$ the coefficients $0,0,1,0,1$ correspond to the fourth row of the triangle (2).
- For $t=1$ the coefficients $1,5,7,4,1$ correspond to the fourth row of the triangle (3).
- For $t=2$ the coefficients $16,34,25,8,1$ correspond to the fourth row of the triangle (4).
- For $t=3$ the coefficients $81,111,55,12,1$ correspond to the fourth row of the triangle (5).

10. Multifold Sums of Powers in Binomial Form

By Lemma (3.8), and by Theorem (8.1) yields

Proposition 10.1 (Multifold binomial sums of powers)**.** *For non-negative integers n, m, and an arbitrary integer t,*

$$\Sigma^r\, n^m = \frac{1}{2}\sum_{k=0}^{m}\left\{\binom{n-t+\frac{k}{2}+r}{k+r}+\binom{n-t+\frac{k}{2}+r-1}{k+r} - \sum_{s=0}^{r-1}\left[\binom{r-s-t+\frac{k}{2}}{k+r-s}+\binom{r-1-s-t+\frac{k}{2}}{k+r-s}\right]\binom{s+n-1}{s}\right\}\delta^k t^m.$$

For example,

Example 10.2 (Examples of multifold binomial sums)**.** *For integer $0 \le t \le 2$*

$$t=0: \quad \Sigma^r\, n^m = \frac{1}{2}\sum_{k=0}^{m}\left\{\binom{n+\frac{k}{2}+r}{k+r}+\binom{n+\frac{k}{2}+r-1}{k+r} - \sum_{s=0}^{r-1}\left[\binom{r-s+\frac{k}{2}}{k+r-s}+\binom{r-1-s+\frac{k}{2}}{k+r-s}\right]\binom{s+n-1}{s}\right\}\delta^k 0^m,$$

$$t=1: \quad \Sigma^r\, n^m = \frac{1}{2}\sum_{k=0}^{m}\left\{\binom{n-1+\frac{k}{2}+r}{k+r}+\binom{n-1+\frac{k}{2}+r-1}{k+r} - \sum_{s=0}^{r-1}\left[\binom{r-s-1+\frac{k}{2}}{k+r-s}+\binom{r-2-s+\frac{k}{2}}{k+r-s}\right]\binom{s+n-1}{s}\right\}\delta^k 1^m,$$

$$t=2: \quad \Sigma^r\, n^m = \frac{1}{2}\sum_{k=0}^{m}\left\{\binom{n-2+\frac{k}{2}+r}{k+r}+\binom{n-2+\frac{k}{2}+r-1}{k+r} - \sum_{s=0}^{r-1}\left[\binom{r-s-2+\frac{k}{2}}{k+r-s}+\binom{r-3-s+\frac{k}{2}}{k+r-s}\right]\binom{s+n-1}{s}\right\}\delta^k 2^m.$$

By setting $t \to -t$ we get negated version of Proposition (10.1)

Proposition 10.3 (Multifold binomial sums of powers negated)**.** *For non-negative integers n, m, and an arbitrary integer t,*

$$\Sigma^r\, n^m = \frac{1}{2}\sum_{k=0}^{m}(-1)^{m+k}\left\{\binom{n+t+\frac{k}{2}+r}{k+r}+\binom{n+t+\frac{k}{2}+r-1}{k+r} - \sum_{s=0}^{r-1}\left[\binom{r-s+t+\frac{k}{2}}{k+r-s}+\binom{r-1-s+t+\frac{k}{2}}{k+r-s}\right]\binom{s+n-1}{s}\right\}\delta^k t^m.$$

Proof. By setting $t \to -t$ into Proposition (10.1), and by $\delta^k(-t)^m = (-1)^{m+k}\delta^k t^m$. □

There are indeed many (infinitely) variations of such formulas as above, at least for every integer t. However, this entropy can be even wilder, by recalling the fundamental properties of binomial coefficients, such as

$$\binom{-x}{k} = (-1)^k \binom{x+k-1}{k},$$
$$\binom{x}{k} = \binom{x}{x-k}.$$

11. Framework for Sums of Powers

In this manuscript, we derive formulas for sums of powers by combining centered Newton's interpolation formula for powers (3.2) with hockey-stick identities (3.6), and (3.7). This approach can be generalized further. In particular, while using Newton's formulas

$$\begin{cases} f(x) &= \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{(x-a)^{[k]}}{k!} \delta^k f(a) = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{x-a}{k} \binom{x-a+\frac{k}{2}-1}{k-1} \delta^k f(a), \\ f(x) &= \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{(x-a)_k}{k!} \Delta^k f(a) = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \binom{x-a}{k} \Delta^k f(a), \\ f(x) &= \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{(x-a)^{(k)}}{k!} \nabla^k f(a) = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \binom{x-a+k-1}{k} \nabla^k f(a), \\ f(x) &= \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{(x-a)^k}{k!} \frac{\mathrm{d}^k f(a)}{\mathrm{d}x^k}. \end{cases} \tag{2}$$

one may replace linear difference operators δ, Δ, ∇ with their non-linear dynamic analogs, allowing more generic approach for sums of powers. It is indeed so remarkable that Taylor's series $f(x) = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{(x-a)^k}{k!} \frac{\mathrm{d}^k f(a)}{\mathrm{d}x^k}$ is a continuous analogue of Newton's formula! Back to the topic, such non-linear difference operators arise naturally in the theory of dynamic equations on time scales, developed by Bohner and Peterson in [17]. Thus, the discrete change $x+h$ of a function $f(x+h)$ is replaced by function $g(h)$ which implies that dynamic difference operator is

$$D_g f = \frac{f(g(x)) - f(x)}{g(x) - x}. \tag{3}$$

A well-known example is Jackson's q-difference [18]

$$D_q f(x) = \frac{f(qx) - f(x)}{qx - x},$$

where $g(x) = qx$. In particular, for Newton's formula in linear differences δ, Δ, ∇, their respective falling, rising, and central factorials are related to binomial coefficients via

$$\begin{cases} \frac{(x)_n}{n!} & = \frac{1}{n!}x(x-1)(x-2)\cdots(x-n+1) = \binom{x}{n}, \\ \frac{x^{(n)}}{n!} & = \frac{1}{n!}x(x+1)(x+2)\cdots(x+n-1) = \binom{x+n-1}{n}, \\ \frac{x^{[n]}}{n!} & = \frac{1}{n!}\left(n+\frac{k}{2}-1\right)\left(n+\frac{k}{2}-2\right)\cdots\left(n-\frac{k}{2}+1\right) = \frac{x}{n}\binom{x+\frac{n}{2}-1}{n-1}. \end{cases} \tag{4}$$

Motivated by this viewpoint, we can see that dynamic version of Newton's formula is

$$f(x) = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{(x \mid \alpha, \beta)_k}{k!} \cdot D_g f(a), \tag{5}$$

where a is an arbitrary integer, $D_g f(a)$ is dynamic difference operator, and $(x \mid \alpha, \beta)_n$ is generalized factorial which uses the combination of Nörlund's notation [19], and definition given by Steffensen [9]

Definition 11.1 (Generalized factorial)**.** *For non-negative integers* x, n, α, β

$$(x \mid \alpha, \beta)_n = x(x - n\alpha - \beta)(x - n\alpha - 2\beta)\cdots(x - n\alpha - n - I\beta).$$

For instance,

$$\begin{cases} (x)_n & = (x \mid \alpha, \beta)_n, \quad \alpha = 0, \quad \beta = 1, \quad \text{(forward Newton's formula)} \\ x^{(n)} & = (x \mid \alpha, \beta)_n, \quad \alpha = 0, \quad \beta = -1, \quad \text{(backward Newton's formula)} \\ x^{[n]} & = (x \mid \alpha, \beta)_n, \quad \alpha = \frac{1}{2}, \quad \beta = 1, \quad \text{(central Newton's formula)} \\ x^n & = (x \mid \alpha, \beta)_n, \quad \alpha = 0, \quad \beta = 0, \quad \text{(Taylor's formula)} \end{cases}$$

More precisely, the algorithm for closed formulas for sums of powers is

Algorithm 11.2 (Algorithm for closed formulas)**.**

(1) Define the function $f(x) = x^m$.

(2) Pick generalized difference operator $D_g f(x)$, *see* (3). *In this paper, we use central difference* $\delta^k f(x)$.

(3) Derive generalized Newton's formula (5) *in terms of* $D_g f(x)$, *for example one of* (2).

(4) *Find an identity that connects respective factorials* $(x \mid \alpha, \beta)_n$ *with binomial coefficients of the form* $\binom{x}{k}$*, so that upper index is expression in* x*. In this manuscript, we use Lemma* (3.3)*, and Lemma* (3.4)*, however they may vary, based on selected difference operator, which is central difference* $\delta^k f(x)$ *for this work.*

(5) *Apply hockey-stick identities, to derive closed form for sums of powers* $\Sigma^1 n^m$*. The precise hockey-stick identities may vary, depending on factorials* $(x \mid \alpha, \beta)_n$*, in this work we use Lemma* (3.6)*, and Lemma* (3.7)*.*

(6) *Apply hockey-stick identities repeatedly, to get formula for multifold sums of powers* $\Sigma^r n^m$*, for example, Theorem* (5.7)*, and Theorem* (8.1)*.*

The algorithm above has already been utilized in practice. For instance, the work [20] provides remarkable formulas for sums of powers, based on forward difference Newton's formula,

Proposition 11.3. *For non-negative integers* r, n, m *and an arbitrary integer* t*,*

$$\Sigma^r n^m = \sum_{j=0}^{m} \left[\binom{n-t+r}{j+r} + \sum_{s=1}^{r} (-1)^{j+s-1} \binom{j+t-1}{j+s} \binom{r-s+n-1}{r-s} \right] \Delta^j t^m.$$

Also, in terms of Eulerian numbers $\left\langle {n \atop k} \right\rangle$

Proposition 11.4. *For non-negative integers* r, n, m *and an arbitrary integer* t*,*

$$\Sigma^r n^m = \sum_{j=0}^{m} \sum_{k=0}^{m} \left[\binom{n-t+r}{j+r} - \sum_{s=1}^{r} \binom{s-t}{j+s} \binom{r-s+n-1}{r-s} \right] \binom{t+k}{m-j} \left\langle {m \atop k} \right\rangle.$$

The work entitled *Sums of powers of integers and generalized Stirling numbers of the second kind* [21] discusses closed formulas for sums of powers in terms of generalized Stirling numbers of the second kind $\left\{ {k \atop j} \right\}_r$ which originates from forward Newton's formula for powers, evaluated at arbitrary integer t. It is quite interesting that both [21], and [20] reached the same result independently. In [21], we read

Proposition 11.5 (Cereceda (2022))**.** *For non-negative integers n, k, and an arbitrary integer r*

$$\Sigma^1 n^k = \sum_{j=0}^{k} j! \left[\binom{n+1-r}{j+1} + (-1)^j \binom{r+j-1}{j+1} \right] \left\{ k \atop j \right\}_r, \tag{6}$$

$$\Sigma^1 n^k = \sum_{j=0}^{k} j! \left[\binom{n+1+r}{j+1} + \binom{r+1}{j+1} \right] \left\{ k \atop j \right\}_{-r}. \tag{7}$$

Equation (6) is a special case of Proposition [20, Proposition (1.9)].

Proposition 11.6. *For non-negative integers n, m, and an arbitrary integer t*

$$\Sigma^1 n^m = \sum_{j=0}^{m} \left[\binom{n-t+1}{j+1} + (-1)^j \binom{j+t-1}{j+1} \right] \Delta^j t^m.$$

The resulting formula is expressed in terms of generalized Stirling numbers $\left\{ k \atop j \right\}_r$. This implies that finite differences of powers can be expressed in terms of generalized Stirling numbers of the second kind, $\Delta^j t^m = j! \left\{ m \atop j \right\}_t$. Equation (7) is a special case of Proposition [20, Proposition (1.8)], with $t = -r$.

Proposition 11.7. *For non-negative integers n, m, and an arbitrary integer t,*

$$\Sigma^1 n^m = \sum_{j=0}^{m} \left[\binom{n+t+1}{j+1} - \binom{1+t}{j+1} \right] \Delta^j (-t)^m.$$

Moving discussion to backward Newton's formula, the work [22] utilizes algorithm (11.2) in terms of backward differences, providing another remarkable formula

Proposition 11.8. *For non-negative integers r, n, m and an arbitrary integer t,*

$$\Sigma^{r+1} n^m = \sum_{j=0}^{m} \left[\binom{j-t+n+r}{j+r+1} + \sum_{s=0}^{r} (-1)^{j+s} \binom{t}{j+s+1} \binom{r-s+n-1}{r-s} \right] \nabla^j t^m.$$

Finally, the work [23] explores Newton's formula in central differences, allowing it to be applied with algorithm (11.2). Essentially, it achieves similar formulas for sums of powers as current paper, but using different binomial identities to reach the closed form. For instance,

Proposition 11.9. *For non-negative integers r, n, m and an arbitrary integer t,*

$$\Sigma^r\, n^m = \binom{r+n-1}{r} t^m + \sum_{k=1}^{m} \frac{\delta^k t^m}{2} \Bigg\{ \left[\binom{n-t+\frac{k}{2}+r}{k+r} + \binom{n-t+\frac{k}{2}+r-1}{k+r} \right] - \sum_{s=0}^{r-1} \left[\binom{-t+\frac{k}{2}+r-s}{k+r-s} + \binom{-t+\frac{k}{2}+r-s-1}{k+r-s} \right] \binom{s+n-1}{s} \Bigg\}.$$

This matches Theorem (8.1), which however was derived using the following binomial identity, for non-negative integers r, n, m

$$n\binom{n+r}{m} = (m+1)\binom{n+r}{m+1} - (r-m)\binom{n+r}{m},$$

instead of using Lemma (3.3).

12. Conclusions

The main results establish an algorithm (11.2) for deriving closed formulas for multifold sums of powers of integers by combining variations of Newton's interpolation formula with hockey-stick identities for binomial coefficients.

Using this algorithm, we obtain several notable results, including a closed formula for sums of powers in Proposition (4.1), a formula for r-fold sums of powers in Theorem (8.1), and a pure binomial representation of r-fold sums of powers, in Proposition (10.1).

Furthermore, we show that Knuth's famous formula for sums of odd powers (5.1) originates from Newton's interpolation formula (3.2), thereby obtaining its r-fold generalization in Proposition (5.2).

Motivated by Knuth's formula for odd powers, we also employ the centered Newton interpolation formula evaluated at zero to derive another closed formula for sums of powers in Proposition (5.5). This approach is extended to the r-fold case in Theorem (5.7), and its pure binomial counterpart is established in Proposition (5.8).

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Mathematica Programs

The Mathematica programs in the project repository validate the results; Table 7 lists their functions and outputs.

Mathematica Function	**Validates / Prints**
`MultifoldSumOfPowersRecurrence[r, n, m]`	Computes $\Sigma^r\, n^m$, (2.1)
`CentralFactorial[n, k]`	Computes $n^{[k]}$, (2.3)
`ValidateCentralFactorialsBinomialDecomposition.txt`	Validates Lemma (3.4)
`ValidateNewtonsFormulaForPowers.txt`	Validates Lemma (3.5)
`ValidateCenteredHockeyStickIdentity.txt`	Validates Lemma (3.7)
`ValidateOrdinarySumsOfPowersDecomposition.txt`	Validates Proposition (4.1)
`ValidateMultifoldSumsKnuthFormula.txt`	Validates Proposition (5.2)
`ValidateOrdinarySumsOfPowersAtZero.txt`	Validates Proposition (5.5)
`ValidateDoubleSumsOfPowersAtZero.txt`	Validates Proposition (5.6)
`ValidateMultifoldSumsOfPowersAtZero.txt`	Validates Theorem (5.7)
`ValidateDoubleSumsOfPowersDecomposition.txt`	Validates Proposition (7.1)
`ValidateTripleSumsOfPowersDecomposition.txt`	Validates Proposition (7.3)
`ValidateMultifoldSumsOfPowersTheorem.txt`	Validates Theorem (8.1)
`ValidateMultifoldSumsOfZeroPowersLemma.txt`	Validates Lemma (3.8)
`ValidateMultifoldBinomialSumsOfPowersProposition.txt`	Validates Proposition (10.1)
`ValidateMultifoldBinomialSumsOfPowersNegated.txt`	Validates Proposition (10.3)

Table 7. Mathematica programs and the results they validate or print.

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